

Writing Process / Skills

What is Writing?

Writing is the act or process of producing and recording words in a form, that can be heard and understood.

Nature of Writing:

Unlike speaking or listening, writing is not an innate or natural skill.

Speaking and listening is an inborn skills whereas writing is not inborn skill.

Writing skills does not come by chance.

There is a set of skills required to write simple, clearly, accurately and concisely.

We need to learn writing

skill consciously.

- we start communication through writing at a later stage of our intellectual development.
- Unlike speaking and listening, it is a more complex tool of communication.
- Unlike speaking, as a tool of communication, writing is not temporary rather permanent and everlasting.

The Purpose of Writing:

(i) Writing To Inform:

{ Discuss facts not opinions } ← Note

- when the writer wants to provide and explain information.

The writing is called informative writing.

- It is also called expository writing because it expresses ideas and facts.

- The focus of informative writing are subject, matter, facts, scientific data studies and statistics discussion. ^{debate} above personal liking or (impartial information)
- It is based on objectivity.

Writing to Persuade (convince) (Discuss opinion not facts)

↑
Note

- Persuasive writing aims at convincing the reader about a matter that is debatable (conflicted)
- It expresses opinion rather than facts.
- This writing is also called argumentative, as it supports and argues for certain view points or position.
- In persuasive writing, the writer attempts to change the thinking of the reader

- and bring it closer to his/her own way of thinking.
- It is based on subjectivity.
(Partial View, Personal liking or disliking)

Clarity in writing

An Unimportant requirement for effective writing is to recognize the needs, expectations, fears and attitude of the audience or receiver and the written message.

- Clarity means to send/give the clear sense of the message to the receiver particularly in writing.
- The writer should think carefully about the topic before writing and then write with fully clarity that the reader can easily understand.

Principles of Effective Writing

1- Accuracy

To achieve accuracy, the writer should check and double check

- All facts and figures.

variability should be adopted

- The choice of words
- The language and Tone.

A message should be written in accurate manner not only in facts and figures but also in terms of grammar, punctuation and spellings.

Brevity: ^{مِعْد} (Don't beat about the bush)

Sheikhsparsa said: Brevity is the soul of wit / will. A good written message must be as brief as possible.

The writer should write every thing about the topic but he should not beat about the bush.

- Brevity is not to be achieved at the cost of clarity
- Vague words and expressions should be avoided.

7C's (clarity, correctness, conciseness, courtesy, concentration, completeness, correctness)

language, tone and levels of formalities

Use of Language :

The secret of good writing lies in the use of correct use of language. The language of a written piece must be simple and comprehensible. It must be easily understood.

- The language should also observe the norms of correct language.
- It should be grammatically correct.
- Spellings, sentences, construction, tenses, expression, material must be correct and upto the work.

The tone of the language must caters the need of the reader.

Standard ENGLISH:

Standard English includes the most commonly used and accepted words - It is considered "standard" because it follows the norms laid down by the rules of grammar, sentence,

construction, punctuation, spellings, tenses, expressions and material

TONE :

After determining the purpose and audience about whom writing is going to make, one has to choose the appropriate tone in terms of formality.

- Tone refers to feelings created by words used to communicate a message.
- The tone of a piece of writing basically depends upon the relationship between the writer and those who receive the message.
- The tone is also determined whether the writing is made as upward, downward or horizontally communication.
- The tones can be
 - a) Informal
 - b) Semi formal
 - c) Strictly formal

INFORMAL TONE:

A writer uses an informal tone for social or personal communication and for informal writing.

- Deviation from Standard English
- The informal tone includes the use of slang, colloquialisms and regional words.
- The writer may also include contractions and incomplete sentences.

COLLOQUIALISMS:

Colloquialisms are casual words or phrases used in informal writing. Eg. "guy" for a person, "ain't" for "can't", "is not" or "are not".

SLANG:

Slang consists of

informal words, phrases or meanings that are not regarded as standard and are often used by a specific profession, class and so on.

REGIONAL WORDS:

Regional words are used primarily in particular geographic areas. E.g. phone, bazar.

★ SEMI FORMAL TONE:

The semi formal tone lies somewhere between informal and academic.

- It is expressed mostly through standard English and is written according to the sentence structure and spellings with few contractions that adds a sense of informality.

STRICTLY FORMAL TONE:

The strictly formal tone is scholarly and uses words that are long and not frequently spoken in everyday conversation.

NATURAL LANGUAGE:

Some writings are made in the language of everyday speech. E.g. letters and memos, etc.

ACTIVE VOICE:

- Subject: The subject is that about which something is said.
- Predicate: is whatever is said about the subject.
- Writing must be in Active Voice and not in passive voice.

SEXIST LANGUAGE /

Masculine WORDS:

Sexist language consists of words or phrases that shows bias against the competence or importance of women.

- Avoid: the use of "he" in case of all genders.

Writing As A Tool OF COMMUNICATION -

1. An active skill.
2. Good writing depends on good reading.
3. Written communication as a chain.
4. Importance of language.
5. Mixes the private and public domain.
6. A very effective Tool.